

18 A

$$E_q = k \frac{q}{r_q^2} = k \frac{q}{0.40^2} = 12 \text{ N C}^{-1}$$

$$kq = 1.92$$

$$\begin{aligned} E_{\text{total}} &= E_q + (-E_{-q}) \\ &= k \frac{q}{r_q^2} + \left(-k \frac{-q}{r_{-q}^2} \right) \\ &= \frac{1.92}{0.40^2} + \frac{1.92}{0.60^2} \\ &= 17.3 \text{ N C}^{-1} \end{aligned}$$